Adrian Armas Braithwaite

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Summary

Third-year Ph.D. student in Economics at the University of Michigan. Fields of interest: Macroeconomics, International Finance, and Trade.

Education

2023- Ph.D. in Economics, University of Michigan
Fields: Macroeconomics and Trade
Passed Microeconomics and Macroeconomics with distinction

2016-18 M.Sc. in Economics and Finance, Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros (CEMFI), Madrid, Spain
Thesis: Bank Liquidity Management in a Bi-Monetary Banking System
Advisor: Nezih Guner

2012-15 M.Sc. in Economics, Universidad del Pacífico, Lima, Peru
Thesis: Manejo de Liquidez en una Economía Totalmente Dolarizada
Advisor: Saki Bigio

2014-16 First year courses in M.Sc. in Applied Mathematics, Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú, Lima, Peru

2008-13 B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad del Pacífico, Lima, Peru

PhD Coursework

Math for Economists, Microeconomic Theory I, Microeconomic Theory II, Microeconomic Theory III, Microeconomic Theory IV, Macroeconomic Theory I, Macroeconomic Theory II, Econometric Analysis I, Econometric Analysis II, Stabilization Policy (Macroeconomic field sequence), International Trade, International Finance, Corporate Finance, Theoretical Models in Finance II, Computational Economics, Advanced Mathematical Methods for Dynamic Models

Research

Working Papers

- "Dollarization Hysteresis and Expectation Formation" (Third Year Paper)
  There is persistence of deposit dollarization despite decades of inflation stability. I propose that heterogeneous beliefs about inflation and currency depreciation, formed through experience-based learning (EBL), explain why older cohorts maintain higher foreign-currency deposits than younger cohorts. Using an overlapping-generations model with endogenous currency portfolio choice and EBL for expectation formation I will show past experiences, belief updating and demography shapes the aggregate dollarization persistence. The reduced form evidence uses household financial survey data from Uruguay to quantify how past inflation experiences determines current deposit dollarization across cohorts.

- "Fertility Free-Riding and Optimal Transfers" with Brian C. Fujiy
  U.S. fertility has declined for decades, threatening long-run economic growth. This paper identifies a fertility free-riding problem: additional births generate positive externalities for society, but some individual families bear all the costs and the society do not capture the full social value. We develop an optimal transfer system by embedding a semi-endogenous growth model into an overlapping-generations framework with endogenous fertility, capturing both intensive (number of children) and extensive (share of families with children) margins. Using American Community Survey data, we will analyze if fertility is inefficiently low and see the effects of implementing optimal transfers on U.S. fertility rates and long-run growth.

- "Exchange Rate Determination and Optimal FXI Policy: The Role of Portfolio and Liquidity Shocks" with Marco Ortiz
  A group of Central banks intervene in the FX markets while having an inflation targeting regime. This paper develops a framework that guides the instrument choice by central banks. We develop an incomplete and segmented financial markets for exchange rate determination in which financial intermediaries price FX costs and liquidity trade-offs. In this framework we analyze optimal FXI policy with spot and derivatives. Published in SBS Peru Working Paper Series.
  Presented at: Money, Macro and Finance Society Annual Meeting (2022), INFER Annual Meeting (2022), Banco Central de Reserva del Perú Seminar (2022), Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú Seminar (2022), Banco Central de Reserva del Perú Annual Meeting (2022), LACEA LAMES Annual Meeting (2022).

Previous Work

- "Default on Debt Payment and Loss of Formal Employment in Peru"
  Quantifies effect of losing formal employment on debt repayment. Shows losing formal job increases past due days by 8.7 days per quarter, with heterogeneous effects by income and age. Published in SBS Peru Working Paper Series.
- "Liquidity Management in a Bi-Monetary Banking System" (CEMFI M.Sc. Thesis)
  Banking model for bi-monetary system with local and foreign currency. Banks access exchange rate, FX-swap, and interbank markets. Analyzes U.S. monetary policy spillovers and FX swap market dynamics. Published in SBS Peru Working Paper Series.
  Presented at: Asociación Peruana de Economía Annual Meeting (2019), Banco Central de Reserva del Perú Annual Meeting (2019)
- "Liquidity Management in a Total Dollarized Economy" (Universidad del Pacífico M.Sc. Thesis)
  Banking model for totally dollarized economy without lender of last resort. Shows some parameter configurations generate narrow banking strategy. Published in SBS Peru Working Paper Series.

Professional Experience

2018-23 Research Analyst, Superintendence of Banks, Insurance Companies, and Private Pension Funds, Lima, Peru
Elaboration of Working Papers and Policy Reports. Intensive use of financial administrative data.

Research Assistant

2024-25 Chris House, Univesity of Michigan, United States, Michigan (During Summer)
Received research guidance from Chris on my working papers.

2017 Josep Pijoan-Mas, Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros, Madrid, Spain (During Summer)
Database management for the paper Public Sector Projects, Finance, and Aggregate Productivity (with Julian di Giovanni, Manuel Garcia-Santana, and Enrique Moral-Benito)

2015-16 Oswaldo Molina (Ph.D. Oxford), Universidad del Pacífico, Lima, Peru
External consultant on project: Climate Change and Child Health - Development of Child Vulnerability Indices (with Victor Saldarriaga). Discussion on empirical strategy, redaction, econometric estimations, and database management

2014 Juan Mendoza (Ph.D. Brown), Universidad del Pacífico Research Center
Projects on fiscal multiplier and GDP forecasting

2013 Matthew Bird (Ph.D. Chicago), Universidad del Pacífico Research Center
Projects on applied experimental economics and cultural economics

2011-12 Eduardo Moron (Ph.D. UCLA), Universidad del Pacífico Research Center
Projects on macroeconomics

Awards, Fellowships, and Scholarships

- Research Grant from ASBANC (Asociación de Bancos del Perú) for the paper "Exchange Rate Determination and Optimal FXI Policy: The Role of Portfolio and Liquidity Shocks" with Marco Ortiz (US$15,000, 2023)

- Full scholarship in M.Sc. in Economics and Finance at CEMFI
- Partial scholarship for living expenses in M.Sc. in Economics and Finance at CEMFI (€10,000)
- Scholarship for being ranked first in each semester of M.Sc. in Economics at Universidad del Pacífico (approximately US$15,000)

Programming Skills

Matlab (advanced), Stata (advanced), Julia (intermediate), R (intermediate), EViews (intermediate), Python (basic), Visual Basic (basic), LaTeX (advanced)

Teaching Experience

University of Michigan, Economics Department

2024-2025 GSI, Money and Banking

Universidad del Pacífico, Economics Department

2021 Lecturer, Monetary Theory

2016 Lecturer, Introduction to Macroeconomics

Universidad del Pacífico, Graduate School

2013-20 Teacher Assistant: Advanced Macroeconomics I (2013, 2014, 2019, 2020), Advanced Microeconomics II (2014), Advanced Macroeconomics II (2016), Advanced Econometrics I (2019)

Universidad del Pacífico, Economics Department

2011-15 Teacher Assistant: Macroeconomics I (2011, 2012), Introduction to Microeconomics (2012), Mathematics IV (2014), Econometrics II (2014), Macroeconomics II (2014, 2015)

Languages

Spanish (native) | English (fluent)

References

Marco Ortiz
Professor, Economics Department
Universidad del Pacífico

Saki Bigio
Professor, Economics Department
UCLA

Nezih Guner
Professor, Economics Department
CEMFI

Stephen Terry
Associate Professor, Economics Department
University of Michigan

Toni Whited
Professor, Economics Department
University of Michigan

Rudi Bachmann
Professor, Economics Department
University of Michigan